IELTS FOUNDATION · UNIT 8

Health and Medicine

Staying healthy, relaxing and giving good advice

Vocabulary | Grammar | Reading | Listening | Writing | Speaking

Mindset for IELTS Foundation · Unit 8 · Book pp. 92–102

LEARNING GOAL

Talk and write about staying healthy and relaxing, and give a friend good advice

Objectives: you will…

- identify a speaker’s attitudes and feelings
- recognise distractors
- use words for healthy activities and ways to relax
- understand a writer’s views
- use should / shouldn’t and have to / don’t have to
- describe a picture and write an email giving advice

Success criteria: I can…

- find the key words before I listen
- choose the option that matches exactly
- use do, go, play and get with activities
- say what the writer thinks, not other people
- give advice with should and reasons with because
- write 80–100 words of advice

IELTS STRATEGIES

Test habits to build in this unit

LISTENING

Find the **key words**. Questions follow the order of the recording.

Tip 03, p. 93

READING

Skim for the main idea, then **scan** for details.

Tip 06, p. 94

READING

One answer is correct; two are **distractors**. Match the text **exactly**.

Exam strategy and Tip 08, p. 95

SPEAKING

This picture shows… · It looks like… · I think… because…

Tip 14, p. 97

LISTENING

All three options may be mentioned; only **one** matches exactly.

Tip 17, p. 98

LEAD-IN

How do you keep healthy?

What sport do you play?

How do you like to keep healthy?

Which activities do you enjoy? Why?

Which is harder for you: eating well, sleeping enough or exercising?

LISTENING 1 · MATCHING OPINIONS

Who said it?

Joining the gym is too expensive.

Running is a boring way to exercise.

It is more fun to exercise with other people.

It is better to exercise outdoors.

IELTS STRATEGY

Identify the **key words** in each sentence.

The sentences are in the **same order** as the conversation.

VOCABULARY

Healthy activities: which verb?

play

tennis · basketball · football

go

cycling · swimming · for a walk

do

yoga · exercise · sport

get / drink / eat

enough sleep · water · fruit and vegetables

Ask a partner: “How often do you…?” “Is it healthy? Why?”

READING · AN OPINION ESSAY

Agree or disagree?

Essay question: Students who are studying for important school exams should stop sports lessons. Discuss.

Skim (2 minutes): Which activities does the essay talk about?

Does the writer **agree** or **disagree**? Find *However, I…*

IELTS STRATEGY

First **skim** quickly to understand the main idea.

Then read again at normal speed and **scan** for details.

READING · MULTIPLE CHOICE

One answer, two distractors

"Many young people prefer to spend their free time indoors on their computers or watching TV."

A

riding their bikes **(mentioned, but not what they prefer)**

B

in the park **(mentioned, but not what they prefer)**

C

in front of their computers ✓ **matches exactly**

IELTS STRATEGY Highlight key words · find the paragraph · the other two options are **distractors**

GRAMMAR 1 · SHOULD / SHOULDN'T

Giving advice

	should	shouldn't / should not
Use	a good idea; advice for something	a bad idea; advice against something
Example	You **should** eat more fruit.	You **shouldn't** sit all day.
Question	**Should** I see a doctor?	—

should + verb: not "should to eat", "shoulds", or "Children should have...?"

SPEAKING · DESCRIBING A PICTURE

General → specific → opinion

1 **This picture shows** a boy in his bedroom. **There is** a computer and a bed.

2 **It looks like** the boy is tired. **I think** he is playing a game.

3 **I think** he **should** go to sleep **because** it's late.

IELTS STRATEGY

Start: *This picture shows…*, *In this picture, I can see…*, *There is / are…*

More specific: *It looks like…*, *I think* + present continuous

Opinion: *I think… because…*, *He should / shouldn't…*

VOCABULARY AND LISTENING 2

How do you relax?

Ways to relax

drink tea · do yoga · go for a walk · do exercise · read a book

IELTS STRATEGY

Look carefully at the **first part** of the question.

The speaker may mention details like **all three** options, but only **one** matches exactly.

Listen for: **but**, **now**, **for me**, **actually**. The answer often comes after them.

GRAMMAR 2 · HAVE TO / DON’T HAVE TO

Rule or choice?

	have to / has to	don’t have to / doesn’t have to
Use	rules and laws; a need or obligation	a choice; NO need or obligation
I / you / we / they	We **have to** wear a uniform.	We **don’t have to** pay. It’s free.
he / she / it	She **has to** wear glasses.	He **doesn’t have to** work on Sunday.
Question	**Do** you **have to** play sport?	



don’t have to ≠ shouldn’t: “You don’t have to go” = it’s your choice.

GRAMMAR · COMMON MISTAKES

Find the mistake

× Mistake	✓ Correct	Why
You **should to** sleep more.	You **should** sleep more.	no to after should
She **have to** wear glasses.	She **has to** wear glasses.	he / she / it: has to
He **don’t have to** work today.	He **doesn’t have to** work today.	he / she / it: doesn’t
Have we to bring lunch?	**Do we have to** bring lunch?	question: Do + have to
It’s free, so you **shouldn’t** pay.	It’s free, so you **don’t have to** pay.	no need = don’t have to



Find the mistake, say the rule, then write the correct sentence.

WRITING · AN EMAIL TO A FRIEND GIVING ADVICE

Reply to Alice in 80–100 words

1 · Activities

You should… It’s a good idea to…

2 · Relax

To relax, try… You don’t have to…

3 · Why?

It’s important because…

4 · Grammar

should · shouldn’t · have to · don’t have to

Greeting · advice + a **reason** for each idea · closing and your name

WRITING · MODEL

A model email (about 90 words)

Hi Alice,

Thanks for your email. I think you **should** do more exercise. It's a good idea to go cycling or play tennis with friends after school. You **shouldn't** sit at your computer all evening, so take a break every hour and go for a walk. You **don't have to** join an expensive gym!

To relax, try yoga or read a book before bed. You **should** also get enough sleep, about eight hours.

It's important to stay healthy **because** it gives you more energy and helps you feel happier.

Best wishes,
Sam

PAIR PRACTICE

Your turn, together

Student A

Describe a picture: a boy is playing a computer game at midnight. Give him advice.

Student B

Describe a picture: a girl is eating fast food on the bus. Give her advice.

This picture shows… · It looks like… · I think… because… · He / She should / shouldn’t…

REVIEW

Can you…?

- ✓ use do, go, play and get with activities
- ✓ find key words before you listen
- ✓ say what the writer thinks
- ✓ spot the two distractors
- ✓ give advice with should and shouldn’t
- ✓ use have to and don’t have to

Next: the Unit 8 Challenge on the Miss L Gems site.